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What's News

Business & Finance

- ◆ **The largest U.S. oil companies** reported a blockbuster quarter after the Iran war caused a dislocation in global markets that sent energy prices soaring. **A1**
- ◆ **BP put its U.K. North Sea business up for sale**, paving the way to end oil production in its home country after more than half a century. **B10**
- ◆ **Trading Friday pushed** the Dow into positive territory for the month, while the S&P 500 and Nasdaq fell 0.1% and 3.2%, respectively, in July. **B11**
- ◆ **The closure of the Strait of Hormuz** is prompting companies to raise prices on many products to offset their higher commodity and freight costs. **A1**
- ◆ **The Fed's chairman** floated to colleagues the prospect of meeting less often, which would mark a substantial shift in the central bank's operations. **A2**
- ◆ **KKR is near a deal** to take Texas-based medical-device outsourcing company Interger Holdings private. **B11**
- ◆ **Couche-Tard plans** to acquire Polish convenience retailer Zabka for about \$8.7 billion to expand in Central and Eastern Europe. **B10**
- ◆ **Newell Brands raised** its earnings outlook, expecting that receipts from tariff refunds will help offset the rising cost of supplies. **B10**

Worldwide

- ◆ **A day after Trump** heralded a breakthrough in Gaza that would lead to the disarmament of Hamas, the militant group and Israel were at odds over what was actually agreed to. **A1**
- ◆ **Trump ordered** a fresh attack on Iran aimed at getting Tehran to surrender that could begin as soon as this weekend, predicting the country's leaders would buckle. **A8**
- ◆ **FIFA President** Gianni Infantino abandoned his plan to sell part of the World Cup's commercial rights to private investors in the face of global outrage. **A14**
- ◆ **New York state sued** Kalshi, alleging the company runs an illegal gambling operation, after talks about tax revenue and customer protections broke down. **A3**
- ◆ **Former congressman** George Santos will pay more than \$35,000 to settle a regulator's claim that he manipulated wagers on Kalshi over whether he would attend the State of the Union. **A3**
- ◆ **The U.S. Attorney's Office** in Washington, D.C., dropped its case against the three-time Olympian it charged with damaging the Lincoln Memorial Reflecting Pool. **A3**
- ◆ **Arizona, California** and Nevada would take less water from the Colorado River under a proposal by the federal government to conserve the resource. **A3**

PEGGY NOONAN
Anthony Fauci un.masks himself. **A13**

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Spain Pushes Back After Migrants Rush Enclave



CHAOTIC SCENES: Migrants run back to Morocco after Spanish soldiers moved to secure Ceuta. As many as 60,000 migrants streamed into the Spanish territory in North Africa on Thursday and Friday but authorities said most of them left. **A6**

‘The Boss Wants This Money’: Trump’s Fundraising Operation

WASHINGTON—Almost every night in the White House, President Trump calls his fundraiser, Meredith O’Rourke, for an update.

Trump asks O’Rourke which companies and donors have cut checks and which haven’t, and for how much. He often asks her to make much larger financial requests than she was planning—for some donors the ask is \$5 million, for others it is \$50

By Josh Dawsey, Dana Mattioli, Annie Linskey and Emily Glazer

million. And the president gives her names to call, often including people who have recently met with him, according to people with knowledge of the calls. “This is very important to the president. He’s asked me to

call you and ask you for this donation,” O’Rourke has relayed on phone calls with companies, persistently following up with them. In some calls, she has referred to Trump as the boss, saying “the boss wants this money.” In turn, Trump has called her the “princess of darkness” because she is such a “killer” with donors, according to people who have heard his comments.

SoftBank donated \$50 million toward Trump’s presidential library. Apple cut a check for around \$25 million toward his White House ballroom project, while Microsoft gave around \$10 million and Amazon chipped in around \$5 million, according to people familiar with the contributions. Meta Platforms recently gave \$10 million to a Trump-aligned political com-

Israel, Hamas at Odds On Latest Gaza Plan

TEL AVIV—A day after President Trump announced a breakthrough that he predicted would see Hamas relinquish its weapons and power in war-torn Gaza, both Israel

By Feliz Solomon, Suha Ma’ayeh and Abeer Ayyoub

and the Palestinian militant group appeared at odds over what actually was agreed to—and who should make the first move.

On social media Thursday, Trump said the U.S.-designated terrorist group accepted a plan that would lead to its “complete disarmament.” U.S.

officials said the plan would include Israel’s withdrawal from Gaza. That would be a big step forward in a peace process that has been stagnating as the Trump administration struggles to find a way out of the Iran war.

Trump’s optimistic assessment ran up against skepticism in Israel, where many are deeply distrustful that Hamas would willingly disarm, and sets up a potential clash between the White House and Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu.

The Israeli leader, who faces elections this year, is reluctant to accept any plan short of

Apple’s Stock Takes Beating

Firm sees its steepest single-session drop in market cap. **B11**

Largest 1-day market cap declines for U.S. companies

-\$592.7 billion	Nvidia	Jan. 27, 2025
-\$403.3	SpaceX	June 22, 2026
-\$357.8	Apple	Friday
-\$357.4	Microsoft	Jan. 29, 2026
-\$328.2	Nvidia	June 5, 2026

Sources: Dow Jones Market Data; FactSet

Investors Cheer Rise In Prices—For Now

By RYAN DEZEMBER

The continuing closure of the Strait of Hormuz is beginning to hit Americans’ wallets far beyond the pump. Companies say they are raising prices on products ranging from french fries and beer to paint and packaging to offset their own rising commodity and freight costs.

Samuel Adams brewer Boston Beer, Sherwin-Williams, International Paper and Unilever—maker of Dove soap and Hellmann’s mayonnaise—are among the companies that have told investors in recent days that they have raised

In War’s Turmoil, Oil Giants See Huge Windfall

Industry titans post blockbuster earnings as conflict disruptions stoke energy prices

By COLLIN EATON

The largest U.S. oil companies reported a blockbuster quarter after the Iran war caused a dislocation in global markets that sent energy prices soaring.

At ExxonMobil, profits more than doubled from a year earlier to their highest level since 2022, while Chevron reported its highest quarterly earnings on record.

Exxon said high oil-and-gas production and its nearly two dozen refineries from Texas to Singapore pushed earnings to \$14.5 billion.

The total was its highest since the peak of an energy crisis kicked off by Russia’s invasion of Ukraine.

Chevron reported earnings of \$12.1 billion that rose nearly fivefold from the same period last year, driven by record oil-and-gas production and refining throughput.

Both companies raked in cash as the prolonged closure of the Strait of Hormuz waterway between Iran and Oman cut off a big chunk of the world’s fuel supplies.

U.S. oil prices climbed as high as \$112.95 a barrel in the quarter, and gasoline prices surged to the highest levels in

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◆ **BP looks to sell U.K. North Sea business**..... **B10**

‘Naked Dressing’ Is Spreading And It’s Making Things Awkward

Racy outfits pop up at business conferences; ‘I have no idea where to look right now.’

By SUZANNE KAPNER

When Jennifer Epstein wore a sheer lace skirt that showed off her underwear to dinner with her husband, his response—after he regained his ability to speak—was “Where is the rest of your outfit?”

Epstein, a pharmacist in Fort Washington, Pa., said she wasn’t looking for his approval. “It feels empowering,” the 43-year-old said. “It’s a modern kind of feminism that embraces self assurance and femininity on your own terms.”

“Naked dressing” started as a look for publicity-seeking celebrities and fashion designers. Now it is migrating from the runways and red carpets to everyday shoppers—and it’s not exactly going smoothly.

People are showing up in barely-there outfits to business conferences and weddings, prompting shock and discomfort among other attendees.

When Christian Espinosa walked into a dinner during a cybersecurity conference in Scottsdale, Ariz., he did a double take. Seated near him was

OpenAI Plots Revival After Anthropic’s Rise

By BERBER JIN

OpenAI, the company that sparked the AI boom, fell behind rival Anthropic. Now, it’s fighting for a comeback.

Growth of OpenAI’s flagship consumer product, ChatGPT, has slowed. The departure of Fidi Simo, Chief Executive Sam Altman’s heir apparent, prompted a reshuffle of responsibilities among his top deputies. And sales staff are locked in a costly battle to win over lucrative business customers by offering volume discounts and other sweeteners.

Some of OpenAI’s largest investors have privately expressed concerns about the startup’s high cash burn rela-

tive to its growth, people involved in those conversations said, while others have hedged their bets on the company by pouring money into Anthropic.

Meanwhile, Anthropic’s revenue growth has surpassed OpenAI’s, as did its valuation, which is nearing \$1 trillion, powered by the success of coding tool Claude Code. It’s accelerating plans for a fall initial public offering, kicking off meetings with potential investors in which it has emphasized its lead over the ChatGPT-maker, people familiar with those talks said.

“We did not have our best last 12 months ever, which is mostly my fault, but we are

INSIDE



EXCHANGE
The ‘Nostradamus of AI’ didn’t see it coming, and he needed a lifeline from Citadel. **B1**

SPORTS
FIFA drops plan to sell part of World Cup’s commercial rights to private investors. **A14**